

BuyWise Overview

Current product summary as of May 12, 2026.

BuyWise is a Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS web app that helps buyers check a resale listing or retail product link before they spend money. The current product is centered on the analyzer: paste a link, let BuyWise read what it can, confirm anything missing, and get a cautious buyer verdict.

Current Position

- The main product is the link analyzer on the homepage and Analyze Listing flow.
- The old starter product catalog is no longer part of the main user flow. Search and old product insight URLs redirect back to the analyzer.
- The analyzer does not force a pasted link into a saved product guide. This fixes the earlier problem where a MacBook link could be matched to an unrelated Sony camera guide.
- BuyWise now treats unverified market pricing honestly. If it cannot confirm a real market price for the exact item, it says so and keeps the score cautious.

What A User Can Do Today

- Paste a resale or retail product link into the homepage link checker.
- Let BuyWise attempt to extract the page title, source, page summary, and price from public metadata or readable server-rendered content.
- Add extra details manually if the site blocks extraction or if the price/model is unclear.
- Run the analyzer and get a verdict page with a Deal Score, recommendation, risk level, confidence level, suggested offer or buy-under range, pros, cons, red flags, trust signals, questions to ask, and data-source notes.
- Create an account, log in, log out, save verdicts, view saved verdicts, update saved item status, and delete saved items.

Authentication And Saved Items

- Supabase Auth is connected and supports real account creation and login on the live site.
- Saved verdicts sync to Supabase for logged-in users.
- Saved verdicts use row-level security so users can access only their own saved rows.
- If a user is not logged in, saved data can still fall back to local storage where supported.
- Saved item records are now link-verdict based rather than product-guide based.

Current Analyzer Behavior

- BuyWise classifies links as resale or retail based on the source domain when possible.

- Supported source recognition includes eBay, Craigslist, Facebook Marketplace, OfferUp, Mercari, Swappa, Amazon, Best Buy, Walmart, Target, B&H, StockX, GOAT, Adorama, Apple, Dell, Lenovo, Canon, Sony, Trek, and Specialized.
- Facebook Marketplace is intentionally not scraped. BuyWise asks the user to paste details manually instead.
- The extraction route rejects private/local/internal URLs to reduce server-side request risk.
- Tracking parameters, mobile hosts, and common redirect wrapper URLs are normalized before extraction.
- Price extraction uses JSON-LD, OpenGraph/Twitter metadata, data attributes, embedded page data, and visible server-rendered text.
- Low-confidence prices are not trusted. BuyWise ignores or downgrades likely shipping prices, financing/monthly payments, coupons, accessories, warranties, crossed-out prices, related-product prices, and tiny unrelated numbers.
- If the extracted price confidence is too low, BuyWise asks the user to confirm the price before scoring.
- If the user includes a price in pasted details, such as “Price shown is \$999,” BuyWise can use that as a manually confirmed price.

Current Scoring Logic

- The main score is a strict Deal Score out of 100.
- The score combines price confidence, extraction confidence, source reliability, listing completeness, condition wording, red flags, trust signals, and marketplace/source risk.
- The score no longer rewards a low price as a great deal unless the price and details are reliable.
- When no verified market price is available for the exact item, BuyWise does not call the item an excellent deal. It uses cautious labels such as “Unverified Price” or “Needs More Proof.”
- High-risk listings are capped so they cannot receive misleading 90+ scores just because the price looks low.
- Low extraction confidence lowers the final score and is shown clearly to the user.

What The Verdict Page Shows

- Large Deal Score at the top.
- Market Position label, such as Unverified Price or Needs More Proof.
- Recommendation badge, such as Fair price, Risky purchase, Avoid, or Overpriced.
- Risk level: Low, Medium, or High.
- Confidence: High, Medium, or Low, with reasons.
- Suggested offer or retail buy-under range.
- Subscores for Price / Value, Trust / Safety, Condition, Market Fit, and Confidence.

- Why this score breakdown in plain English.
- Red flags, pros, cons, trust signals, questions to ask, and compared-against/data-source notes.
- Better retail and resale moves are shown only when verified alternatives exist. Right now BuyWise does not yet have live alternative sourcing, so it will often say no verified alternatives are available.

What Is Not Fully Built Yet

- BuyWise does not yet have real-time market-comparison data across every product category.
- BuyWise does not yet reliably find better resale or retail alternatives from live sources.
- BuyWise does not scrape Facebook Marketplace.
- BuyWise does not use headless browser scraping, CAPTCHA bypassing, browser farms, or fake extraction.
- Some major retailers and marketplaces block or limit server-side page reading. Best Buy, eBay, Amazon, Apple, Walmart, Target, StockX, GOAT, and similar sites may partially work, fail, or expose only limited data depending on the page.
- Image and screenshot upload is not implemented yet.
- OpenAI analysis is not implemented in this pass.

Current User-Facing Pages

- Homepage: the primary analyzer entry point. Users paste a link and can add extra details.
- Analyze Listing: same core analyzer experience, with a fuller form when manual confirmation is needed.
- Saved: shows saved verdicts for logged-in users or local fallback saved items.
- Auth: Supabase-powered account page for login/signup/logout.
- About Us: explains what BuyWise does for customers.
- Search and old product guide pages redirect to the analyzer because preset product guides are no longer part of the main product.

Known Technical Limits

- Universal link extraction is unrealistic without browser automation, retailer APIs, partnerships, user-uploaded screenshots, or a browser extension.
- Metadata-only extraction is safer and simpler, but less complete than a real browser session.
- Manual confirmation is necessary when a site blocks price, title, or product details.
- The current score is useful as a cautious buyer check, not a complete live market appraisal.

Recommended Next Build Steps

- Improve manual fallback so users can quickly confirm missing price, title, condition, and source without feeling like the flow failed.

- Add screenshot upload and OCR for marketplace listings that block server-side extraction, especially Facebook Marketplace.
- Add real alternative sourcing through safe APIs, affiliate feeds, retailer feeds, or a browser extension approach.
- Add category-aware detail requirements for laptops, phones, cameras, bikes, monitors, consoles, and tools.
- Add better saved verdict history, notes, and comparison over time.

Bottom Line

BuyWise is now a real account-based link analyzer with honest extraction, strict confidence-aware scoring, and saved verdicts. It is not yet a full live market intelligence engine. The next major product challenge is reliable real-world data: better extraction, screenshot support, and trustworthy live alternatives.